

Westbrook University

Office of Academic Affairs

Policy No: ACAD-GRD-001

Effective: August 1, 2024

Revision: 1.0

Undergraduate Grading Policy

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy establishes the grading standards for all undergraduate courses at Westbrook University. It applies to all full-time and part-time undergraduate students enrolled in credit-bearing courses.

The grading system at Westbrook University is designed to accurately reflect each student's mastery of course material and to maintain the academic integrity of the institution's degrees.

2. Letter Grade Scale and Grade Points

The following letter grades and associated grade-point values are used at Westbrook University for all undergraduate coursework:

- A (4.0) — Excellent: Outstanding mastery of all course objectives
- A- (3.7) — Excellent: Near-outstanding performance
- B+ (3.3) — Good: Clearly above-average performance
- B (3.0) — Good: Average to above-average mastery
- B- (2.7) — Good: Marginally above average
- C+ (2.3) — Satisfactory: Meets most course objectives
- C (2.0) — Satisfactory: Meets minimum course requirements
- C- (1.7) — Passing: Marginally meets requirements
- D+ (1.3) — Minimal Pass: Below expectations but passing
- D (1.0) — Minimal Pass: Minimum passing grade
- F (0.0) — Failure: Does not meet course requirements
- W (—) — Withdrawal: No grade-point impact (see Withdrawal Policy)
- I (—) — Incomplete: Temporary grade (see Incomplete Grade Policy ACAD-GRD-005)

3. GPA Calculation

A student's Grade Point Average (GPA) is calculated by dividing the total quality points earned by the total number of credit hours attempted. Quality points are calculated by multiplying the grade-point value by the credit hours of each course.

Example: A student earning a B (3.0) in a 3-credit course earns 9 quality points. Cumulative GPA is recalculated at the end of every semester and reflected on the official transcript within 10 business days after grades are submitted.

Transfer credits accepted by the university do not affect the Westbrook GPA but are noted on the transcript separately.

4. Minimum Passing Requirements

A grade of D (1.0) or higher is considered a passing grade for general elective and free-elective courses. However, courses designated as core requirements, major requirements, or prerequisite courses require a minimum grade of C (2.0) to be considered successfully completed.

Students must maintain a cumulative GPA of 2.0 or higher to remain in good academic standing. Falling below this threshold triggers the Academic Warning and Probation procedures outlined in the Academic Standing Policy (ACAD-GRD-004).

5. Grade Submission Deadlines

Faculty must submit final grades no later than 72 hours after the scheduled final examination for each course. Grades submitted after this deadline are subject to review by the Academic Standards Committee.

Midterm grades for all 100- and 200-level courses are submitted at the mid-point of the semester and serve as advisory indicators for students at risk of course failure.

6. Grade Disputes

Students who believe a final grade is incorrect must first contact their instructor within 10 business days of grade posting. If unresolved, students may escalate to the department chair within an additional 10 business days. Further appeals follow the Grade Change Request Guidelines (ACAD-GRD-003).

7. Related Policies

- ACAD-GRD-002 — GPA Appeals Procedure
- ACAD-GRD-003 — Grade Change Request Guidelines
- ACAD-GRD-004 — Academic Standing Policy
- ACAD-GRD-005 — Incomplete Grade Policy
- ACAD-GRD-006 — Pass/Fail Grading Option